# Acornoodle Books Business Plan and Go to Market Strategy

### A proposed children's publishing imprint of Nelson Grey LLC

Prepared October 9 2026

**Decision recommendation**

Launch four validated titles first, prove conversion and contribution margin, then release the remaining eight in measured waves.

## Executive Summary

Nelson Grey LLC has a finished twelve-title children's coloring-book catalog with 312 distinct illustrations, names, and facts. The strongest commercial route is to launch it as Acornoodle Books, a proposed imprint focused on screen-free discovery for children ages 5–9. The initial positioning is "real things made easy to color": recognizable subjects, bold open shapes, simple settings, object names, and one useful fact on every coloring page.

The market is attractive but crowded. U.S. children's activity-book print sales reached 16.7 million units in 2025, up 18 percent year over year, while the broader children's market grew 3 percent. Growth continued into 2026. Large brands dominate licensed and cozy-cute formats; therefore this plan does not compete on volume of art or cuteness alone. It competes on a repeatable learning format, age-specific usability, coherent series architecture, and trusted quality control.

The recommended launch is a four-title pilot—Roaring Dinosaurs, Crawling Bugs, Working Vehicles, and Cuddly Farm Animals—priced initially at $9.99 in the United States. At current KDP rates, a 60-page 8.5 by 11 inch black-ink large-trim paperback has a $2.84 printing cost; at $9.99 and the 60 percent royalty tier, estimated royalty is about $3.15 per sale before advertising and overhead. These figures must be confirmed in KDP at upload.

The business should not publish all twelve at once. KDP currently limits new paperback title creation and submission to two per week. More importantly, staged release creates learning: the first four titles test cover conversion, themes, pricing, keywords, reviews, returns, advertising economics, and print quality before the rest of the catalog is exposed.

### Decision Summary

| Decision | Recommendation | Reason |
|---|---|---|
| Working imprint | Acornoodle Books | Memorable, child-friendly, expandable beyond coloring; exact phrase showed no obvious publishing collision in a preliminary web screen. |
| Ownership line | An imprint of Nelson Grey LLC | Keeps the consumer brand distinct while preserving corporate ownership. |
| Initial series | Color Learn and Discover | Descriptive series architecture for the existing |

| Decision | Recommendation | Reason |
|---|---|---|
| | | twelve books; confirm availability before public adoption. |
| Launch scope | Four titles over two weeks | Respects current KDP submission limits and creates a controlled commercial test. |
| Primary channel | Amazon KDP paperback | No inventory commitment, global Amazon reach, rapid iteration. |
| Initial U.S. list price | $9.99 | Qualifies for the current 60 percent royalty tier and aligns with major coloring-book price points. |
| Success gate | At least two pilot titles reach 75 paid units and positive contribution within 90 days | Prevents catalog expansion based only on impressions or enthusiasm. |

# Company and Brand Structure

## Business Ownership

Nelson Grey LLC will own the publishing operation, contracts, accounts, files, and revenue. Acornoodle Books is intended as a consumer-facing imprint, not a separate legal entity. The recommended public lockup is “Acornoodle Books, an imprint of Nelson Grey LLC.” Accounting should track the imprint as its own business line inside the LLC.

## Publishing Name Recommendation

Approved imprint name: Acornoodle Books. “Acorn” suggests growth and learning; “noodle” suggests imagination and thinking. The name can support coloring books, activity books, beginner reference books, flash cards, printable packs, and classroom resources without limiting the catalog to one subject or coloring tool.

The name has not received a formal legal clearance opinion. A no-cost preliminary screen completed October 9, 2026 found no exact Acornoodle Books publisher, book series, or exact-match U.S. trademark result in the searches available to the company. The acornoodlebooks.com domain appeared unregistered at the time of the check. Nelson Grey LLC has elected to proceed without attorney review. This evidence reduces uncertainty but does not establish exclusivity or eliminate infringement risk. The company should recheck trademark records, marketplace use, the domain, and social handles immediately before launch and preserve dated search records.

## Backup Names

| Candidate | Strength | Screening note |
|---|---|---|
| Pencil Puddle Press | Playful and highly child-friendly | No obvious exact publishing match found in preliminary web screening; formal search still required. |
| Bright Nib Books | Short, optimistic, and extensible | No obvious exact publishing match found in preliminary web screening; “nib” may be less familiar to young children. |
| Clever Sprig Books | Growth and learning associations | “Clever” is crowded in children’s publishing, increasing similarity risk. |
| Wonderwhisk Books | Warm and memorable | Not recommended: WONDERWHISK is a live U.S. registration for kitchen utensils, creating avoidable expansion and search confusion. |
| Bright Burrow Books | Excellent child appeal | Rejected: an active children’s book brand and website already use the exact name. |

### Brand Promise and Identity

Brand promise: every Acornoodle book gives a child one clear thing to color and one true thing to learn. The parent receives an affordable, screen-free activity with visible educational value; the child receives achievable pages that do not feel babyish.

- Audience voice: warm, curious, capable, and specific. Never patronizing, hyperactive, or classroom-heavy.
- Visual identity: clean white space, bright natural cover colors, consistent title hierarchy, and a small acorn with a playful squiggle or line motif that can become a flexible symbol of growth, curiosity, and discovery.
- Trust signals: exact age range, number of pictures, single-sided pages, names and facts, clear AI disclosure, and physical proof review.
- Avoid: claims of uniqueness, "educationally proven," "best," or developmental outcomes without evidence; imitation of competitor layouts; copyrighted characters; and keyword-heavy cover text.

# Market Opportunity

## Demand

The current market favors hands-on, screen-free products. Publishers Weekly reported 16.7 million U.S. children's activity-book units in 2025, an 18 percent increase from 2024, versus 3 percent growth for children's books overall. The same report said sales were tracking 18 percent above the prior year through May 23, 2026. Circana separately identified activity-based and interactive children's books and screen-free categories—including coloring books—as growth areas in early 2026.

The opportunity is not "all coloring books." It is the intersection of three purchase motives: a child's strong topic interest, a parent's desire for low-friction screen-free time, and a caregiver's preference for an activity that includes learning. This makes dinosaurs, vehicles, bugs, farm animals, birds, and fish durable topics with multiple gift occasions.

## Customer Segments

| Segment | Primary job | Buying trigger | Message |
|---|---|---|---|
| Parents of ages 5–9 | Independent quiet activity with learning value | Rainy day, travel, screen-time replacement, school break | Big, clear pictures plus names and facts. |
| Grandparents and gift buyers | A safe, useful, affordable gift | Birthday, holiday, visit, care package | Match the book to the child's favorite topic. |
| Homeschool families | Supplement a theme or unit study | Animal, science, transport, or nature unit | Color, identify, read one fact, and discuss. |
| Teachers and librarians | Low-prep enrichment | Centers, indoor recess, activity tables | Simple subject pages and accurate labels. |
| Occupational and support settings | Accessible fine-motor activity | Need for broad shapes and manageable detail | Large spaces, bold lines, age-respectful subjects. |

## Competitive Landscape

| Competitor | Observed strength | Gap or implication for Acornoodle |
|---|---|---|
| Jade Summer | Large catalog; bold lines; simple backgrounds; clear age targeting; strong review base | Do not compete on page count. Emphasize realistic identification, facts, and coherent learning series. |
| Coco Wyo | Category-leading cozy style; bold/easy; strong brand and major-publisher distribution | Avoid cozy imitation. Own a realistic, educational, age-specific visual language. |
| Licensed activity books | Immediate character recognition and gift appeal | Do not chase licenses early. Win through evergreen interests and lower development risk. |
| Generic KDP books | Many low-priced topical options and rapid | Differentiate through proofed quality, |

| Competitor | Observed strength | Gap or implication for Acornoodle |
|---|---|---|
| | supply | consistent series design, accurate facts, and durable brand metadata. |
| Early-learning workbooks | Clear parent value and structured skill progression | Future products should add explicit skill outcomes, but only after the coloring line proves demand. |

### Positioning

Positioning statement: For parents and gift buyers choosing screen-free activities for children ages 5–9, Acornoodle Books offers realistic, easy-to-color topic books in which every page names the subject and teaches one memorable fact. Unlike generic coloring collections, the books are designed as a consistent discovery library rather than a pile of unrelated images.

## Product Strategy

### Existing Catalog

| Title | Shelf family | Release |
|---|---|---|
| Crawling Bugs | Nature | Pilot |
| Flying Bugs | Nature | Wave 2 |
| Singing Birds | Nature | Wave 3 |
| Soaring Birds | Nature | Wave 3 |
| Schools of Fish | Ocean | Wave 2 |
| Lonely Fish | Ocean | Wave 2 |
| Roaring Dinosaurs | Dinosaurs | Pilot |
| Sleepy Dinosaurs | Dinosaurs | Wave 2 |
| Busy Farm Animals | Farm | Wave 3 |
| Cuddly Farm Animals | Farm | Pilot |
| Working Vehicles | Vehicles | Pilot |
| Racing Vehicles | Vehicles | Wave 2 |

Each current book contains 26 named coloring subjects with facts in a 60-page, 8.5 by 11 inch single-sided paperback. The production package contains twelve interiors, twelve full-wrap covers, a prompt and provenance manifest, and validation records.

### Recommended Series Architecture

| Layer | Public name | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| Imprint | Acornoodle Books | The long-term consumer publishing brand. |
| Core series | Color Learn and Discover | The existing realistic topic coloring library for ages 5–9. |
| Early learning series | My First Learning Library | Future ABCs, numbers, colors, shapes, fruits, vegetables, and opposites. |

| Layer | Public name | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| Deep-dive series | I Love to Learn About | Future horses, cats, dogs, space, sharks, construction, and weather. |
| Bundles | Discovery Sets | Parent-facing groupings such as Dinosaurs, Ocean, Farm, Nature, and Vehicles. |

The phrase “Learning My” should not be the master brand. It is understandable but less natural than “My First” or “I Love to Learn About.” Use plain, searchable individual titles first, with series language secondary in metadata and on a consistent cover badge.

### Product Quality Gate

1. Run factual review for every label and fun fact, using authoritative sources where the subject could be disputed.
2. Check every illustration for anatomy or mechanical errors, accidental extra subjects, malformed geometry, inappropriate details, hidden text, logos, and near-duplication.
3. Print four physical pilot proofs on white paper. Test crayons, colored pencils, washable markers, and common alcohol markers with a backing sheet.
4. Have at least three adults and six children across ages 5–9 color sample pages. Record ease, engagement time, confusing details, and preferred cover.
5. Correct recurring issues before the first public release. Apply fixes to all twelve books, not only the pilot title where an issue appeared.

## Business Model and Unit Economics

### Revenue Model

The initial model is print-on-demand paperback sales through Amazon KDP. KDP handles production, listing, fulfillment, and customer service. Nelson Grey LLC retains responsibility for content, metadata, rights, pricing, marketing, accounting, taxes, and quality. Later revenue can include direct author-copy bundles, classroom packs, digital printables, licensing, and non-Amazon distribution, but those channels should follow evidence of retail demand.

### KDP Economics

As of October 9, 2026, Amazon.com applies a 60 percent paperback royalty rate at list prices of $9.99 and above and 50 percent at $9.98 and below. A 60-page black-ink paperback in a large trim size such as 8.5 by 11 inches incurs a current fixed printing cost of $2.84 on Amazon.com. The estimated royalty is therefore (royalty rate × list price) – printing cost.

| List price | Rate | Print cost | Est. royalty | Royalty as % of price |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $8.99 | 50% | $2.84 | $1.66 | 18.4% |
| $9.99 | 60% | $2.84 | $3.15 | 31.6% |
| $10.99 | 60% | $2.84 | $3.75 | 34.2% |
| $11.99 | 60% | $2.84 | $4.35 | 36.3% |

Recommended starting price: $9.99. It reaches the current 60 percent threshold and matches prominent coloring-book price points. Test $10.99 only after the detail page has reviews and the added learning value is visible through A+ Content. Recheck costs and thresholds in KDP before every launch because platform economics can change.

### Year One Scenario Model

| Scenario | Paid units | Gross royalties | Marketing and samples | Other cash costs | Indicative contribution |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Conservative | 480 | $1,514 | $1,200 | $900 | –$586 |

| Scenario | Paid units | Gross royalties | Marketing and samples | Other cash costs | Indicative contribution |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Base | 1,440 | $4,542 | $1,500 | $1,100 | $1,942 |
| Growth | 4,320 | $13,625 | $3,800 | $1,700 | $8,125 |

Scenario assumptions use $3.154 estimated royalty per paid unit and exclude owner labor, income tax, sales tax obligations outside marketplace collection, legal fees, and future illustration or editing costs. “Paid units” excludes author copies and giveaways. These are planning cases, not forecasts.

### Break Even Rules

- At $9.99, the absolute advertising break-even ACoS is about 31.6 percent before other expenses. Target 18–22 percent once campaigns stabilize.
- Do not scale a keyword merely because it generates sales. Scale only if attributed royalty exceeds spend and organic rank or review velocity is improving.
- Pause a title after 90 days if it has fewer than 25 paid units, conversion below 5 percent after meaningful traffic, and no improving trend after cover and metadata tests.
- Fund later waves primarily from validated contribution, not from blanket ad spending across twelve unproven listings.

## Go to Market Strategy

### Launch Principles

- Stage the catalog so every release teaches the next release.
- Sell the child’s interest first and the learning value second.
- Build one recognizable imprint and series page rather than twelve isolated listings.
- Use honest previews to overcome uncertainty about AI-generated artwork and interior quality.
- Optimize for contribution and repeat purchase, not launch-week rank screenshots.

### Ninety Day Launch Plan

| Period | Actions | Exit evidence |
|---|---|---|
| Days 1–14 | Complete name clearance; secure domains and handles; create brand system; finalize four pilot covers and metadata; upload no more than two paperback titles per week; order physical proofs. | Clear working name; proof orders placed; metadata checklist complete. |
| Days 15–30 | Correct proofs; publish Roaring Dinosaurs and Crawling Bugs first; add Author Central; build A+ modules; start small Sponsored Products auto and exact campaigns. | Listings live and accurate; first traffic and conversion baseline. |
| Days 31–60 | Publish Working Vehicles and Cuddly Farm Animals; request compliant reviews from genuine readers without incentives; post page demonstrations; test cover thumbnails and descriptions. | At least 20 paid units total; first reviews; usable search-term report. |
| Days 61–90 | Concentrate spend on converting terms; cross-promote the four titles; add comparison chart; assess theme, price, review, return, and ad data. | Go, revise, or stop decision for Wave 2 based on defined gates. |

## Amazon Detail Page

Each listing should lead with the topic and age, then prove usability. The first 200 characters should communicate the subject, 26 pictures, bold open spaces, names and facts, and single-sided pages. Reading age should be set to 5–9 so the book is eligible for age-specific discovery. Select only relevant categories and use accurate two- or three-word keyword phrases; never use competitor names or claims such as “bestselling.”

- Title pattern: “[Topic] Coloring Book for Kids Ages 5–9.” Keep the creative title concise and put descriptive language in the subtitle.
- Description order: child benefit, parent benefit, what is inside, format details, and matching-series invitation.
- A+ Content: brand story, three enlarged interior examples, “what every page includes,” age and tool guidance, and a comparison table of available themes.
- Author Central: use Acornoodle Books consistently as the public imprint identity and connect all titles to one credible profile. Keep Nelson Grey LLC identified as the owner and publisher in copyright and account records.

## Amazon Advertising

| Campaign | Starting setup | Decision rule |
|---|---|---|
| Automatic discovery | $3–5 daily per live title; low bids; separate campaign per ASIN | Harvest relevant converting terms; negate clearly irrelevant searches. |
| Exact topic keywords | 10–20 highly relevant phrases per title | Increase bids only after at least two orders or strong conversion evidence. |
| Product targeting | Comparable non-licensed children’s coloring books | Keep placements only when page relevance and economics are acceptable. |
| Series defense | Target own ASINs after four titles are live | Protect cross-shopping and encourage second-title purchases. |

## Owned and Earned Channels

- Website: one fast landing page for the imprint, a page per shelf family, privacy-safe email signup for adults, and links to Amazon. Do not collect children’s personal data.
- Pinterest: topic boards and completed-page inspiration; strong fit for evergreen parent, teacher, craft, and homeschool search behavior.
- Short video: 10–20 second page flips, crayon demonstrations, before-and-after coloring, and side-by-side age tests. Show the real printed book.
- Email: monthly adult-facing “curiosity page” with one printable sample, one fact, and new-release notice. Avoid child-directed signup language.
- Outreach: homeschool reviewers, elementary librarians, occupational therapists, travel-with-kids creators, and parent newsletters. Offer a proof copy without requiring a positive review.

## Launch Content Calendar

| Week | Theme | Content |
|---|---|---|
| –2 | Why this series exists | Founder note; close-up of bold spaces; age 5–9 design rationale. |
| –1 | Preview | Three interior pages; physical proof arrival; crayon and pencil test. |
| 1 | Dinosaurs | Page flip; child fact quiz; completed T. rex page; Amazon launch link. |
| 2 | Bugs | Ant versus beetle identification; backyard discovery printable. |
| 3 | Vehicles | How machines work fact carousel; favorite vehicle poll for adults. |

| Week | Theme | Content |
|---|---|---|
| 4 | Farm | Baby and working animal pairing; gift-angle post. |
| 5–8 | Proof and community | Reader coloring shares with permission; FAQ; comparison chart; series guide. |

# Sales Funnel and Measurement

## Funnel

Discovery comes from Amazon search, product pages, Pinterest, short-form video, adult email, and outreach. The detail page converts attention into purchase through a clear cover thumbnail, relevant title, visible interior samples, accurate description, reviews, and competitive price. The book converts a first purchase into a series customer through consistent quality, back-matter discovery, and matching products.

## Key Performance Indicators

| Stage | Metric | 90-day guide |
|---|---|---|
| Discovery | Impressions and detail-page sessions | Enough qualified traffic to evaluate conversion; do not use impressions alone as success. |
| Conversion | Orders divided by detail-page sessions | Aim for 7–12%; investigate below 5% after 200 qualified sessions. |
| Economics | Royalty less attributed ad spend | Positive by title over a rolling 30-day window. |
| Advertising | ACoS and cost per order | Target 18–22% ACoS after learning; never exceed 31.6% for long at $9.99. |
| Quality | Rating, return themes, defect reports | Target 4.3+ average; investigate every repeated complaint. |
| Portfolio | Second-title purchase and cross-ASIN clicks | Increase after four-title A+ comparison chart is active. |
| Cadence | New titles passing proof gate | Two pilot titles per week maximum; quality gate controls pace. |

## Experiment Backlog

| Priority | Test | Single variable | Winning criterion |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cover thumbnail | Subject crop and title hierarchy | Higher qualified conversion without higher return rate. |
| 2 | Price | $9.99 versus $10.99 | Higher 30-day contribution, not simply revenue. |
| 3 | Subtitle | Learning benefit wording | Higher organic click and conversion on relevant searches. |
| 4 | A+ examples | Three subject mixes | More cross-ASIN clicks and conversion. |
| 5 | Ad match type | Auto versus exact | Lower cost per paid order at comparable volume. |

| Priority | Test | Single variable | Winning criterion |
|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | Series badge | Descriptive badge placement | Better recognition without reducing topic clarity. |

# Operations Plan

## Publishing Workflow

| Gate | Owner | Required evidence |
|---|---|---|
| Editorial | Nelson Grey LLC | Unique subject list, fact sources, age fit, sensitivity review. |
| Art QA | Publisher plus external reviewer | No malformed subjects, logos, hidden text, duplicate designs, or unsafe scenes. |
| Production | Publisher | 60-page interior, correct trim, matching wrap cover, barcode clearance, embedded fonts. |
| Platform | Publisher | KDP Previewer pass, accurate AI disclosure, categories, reading age, price, rights. |
| Physical proof | Publisher and child testers | Legible labels, usable line weight, acceptable gutter and paper behavior. |
| Launch | Publisher | Final files archived, metadata sheet approved, campaign limits set, monitoring active. |

## Rights and Provenance

The illustration manifest should remain the chain-of-custody record for every page: prompt, subject, generator, reference-image status, accepted asset path, and fact. Because images were generated by AI, KDP requires disclosure during title setup. The current interiors also include a plain-language disclosure. Nelson Grey LLC remains responsible for avoiding infringement and for substantiating its right to distribute the final compilation.

- Do not claim that an image is guaranteed unique or legally protected merely because it was generated from an original prompt.
- Retain dated source files, prompts, accepted outputs, revisions, manifests, and proof approvals.
- Do not use artist names, copyrighted characters, brand logos, vehicle trade dress, or proprietary franchises in future prompts or metadata.
- Use the publisher's original layout, selection, text, facts, and series system as the commercial package; consult counsel on copyright and trademark strategy.

## File and Release Management

- Create one immutable release folder per published edition with interior PDF, cover PDF, metadata sheet, validation report, ISBN, ASIN, publication date, and KDP settings.
- Do not overwrite a published source package. Make a new version and record what changed.
- Keep print files, editable production files, marketing files, legal records, and analytics exports in separate folders with clear retention rules.
- Back up the repository outside the working computer before KDP submission.

# Compliance and Risk Management

| Risk | Probability | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Publishing-name conflict | Medium | High | Formal knockout and comprehensive |

| Risk | Probability | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | search; counsel review; delay logo and ISBN spend until cleared. |
| AI or intellectual-property complaint | Medium | High | Provenance records, no references or imitation, human review, prompt standards, takedown response process. |
| Poor physical usability | Medium | High | Proof every format; tool testing; child testing; revise all related titles. |
| KDP rejection or account action | Low–Medium | High | Accurate AI disclosure, honest metadata, paced submissions, content-guideline review, no review manipulation. |
| Weak conversion | High | Medium | Four-title pilot, thumbnail tests, A+ samples, price test, stop rules. |
| Ad losses | High | Medium | Daily caps, title-level P&L, search-term harvesting, negative keywords, ACoS ceiling. |
| Fact error | Medium | Medium | Source ledger and second-person editorial review before publication. |
| Brand inconsistency | Medium | Medium | One design system, metadata templates, release checklist, centralized asset library. |
| Child privacy issue | Low | High | Market to adults; no child accounts, direct data collection, or behavioral tracking. |
| Platform concentration | High | Medium | Build adult email list and website; test direct bundles only after demand is proven. |

### AI Disclosure Rule

Amazon currently requires publishers to inform KDP when images, text, or translations are AI-generated, including cover and interior artwork, even if the material is substantially edited later. Every title setup and later republication should answer the platform's current disclosure questions accurately. This requirement is operational, not optional.

### Children and Marketing

Advertising and email acquisition should address adults. Website forms should request only the minimum information from adults and should not invite children to submit names, ages, photos, addresses, school information, or artwork without a reviewed parental-consent process. Any customer-shared child artwork or image requires explicit adult permission before reposting.

## Organization and Budget

### Operating Roles

| Role | Initial owner | When to outsource |
|---|---|---|
| Publisher and product lead | Nelson Grey LLC | Retain ownership; outsource specialized tasks only. |
| Editorial and fact review | Owner plus contracted reviewer | Before every new subject set and whenever claims are technical. |

| Role | Initial owner | When to outsource |
|---|---|---|
| Art and production QA | Owner plus independent visual reviewer | Before proofs and after any batch revision. |
| Trademark and publishing counsel | External attorney | Before imprint launch, enforcement, licensing, or disputed content. |
| Advertising operations | Owner initially | After monthly spend exceeds the value of owner time or portfolio complexity grows. |
| Bookkeeping and tax | Qualified professional | At launch and before multi-state/direct sales expansion. |

### Lean Launch Budget

| Item | Planning range | Timing |
|---|---|---|
| Name and trademark search | $500–$2,500 | Before brand commitment; attorney scope drives cost. |
| Domain and basic website | $100–$500 | Before launch. |
| Four physical proofs and shipping | $60–$150 | Pilot preparation. |
| External editorial and art QA | $400–$1,200 | Pilot and catalog remediation. |
| ISBN strategy | $0 with KDP ISBN or current Bowker cost | Decision before print setup; verify current pricing. |
| Amazon advertising | $600–$1,500 | First 90 days with daily caps. |
| Samples and outreach | $150–$400 | First 90 days. |
| Contingency | $250–$600 | Corrections, replacement proofs, or platform changes. |
| Total | $2,060–$6,850 | Excludes owner labor and book-production work already completed. |

## Roadmap

| Phase | Timing | Portfolio decision |
|---|---|---|
| Foundation | 0–30 days | Clear imprint; establish brand system; proof four pilots; prepare metadata and A+ assets. |
| Pilot | 31–90 days | Publish four titles; validate quality, conversion, reviews, price, and ads. |
| Catalog expansion | Months 4–6 | Release Wave 2 only if pilot economics and quality gates pass. |
| Series completion | Months 7–9 | Release remaining titles; build shelf-family bundles and comparison content. |
| Early learning test | Months 9–12 | Prototype ABCs, numbers, fruits, and vegetables; customer-test before production. |
| Channel expansion | Year 2 | Evaluate direct bundles, wholesale, schools, libraries, translations, and licensing. |

### Go No Go Gates

| Gate | Go | Revise | Stop |
|---|---|---|---|
| Name | Professional search finds manageable risk | Similarity concerns can be solved by modifier or design | Material conflict in publishing or education. |
| Proof | No systemic print or art defect | Correctable line, fact, margin, or cover issues | Recurring quality problem requiring catalog rebuild. |
| 90-day demand | Two titles reach 75 paid units and portfolio contribution is positive | Promising traffic but weak conversion; retest cover, price, and page proof | Fewer than 100 total pilot units with no improving signal. |
| Advertising | Portfolio ACoS at or below 25% and improving | 25–32% with usable converting terms | Above break-even after optimization and adequate data. |
| Expansion | Repeat purchase or cross-ASIN behavior visible | One topic works; release only adjacent titles | No evidence that a second title benefits from the first. |

# Immediate Action Plan

1. Adopt Acornoodle Books as the consumer-facing imprint of Nelson Grey LLC, preserve the preliminary screening record, and secure the preferred domain and social handles before public launch.
2. Create a one-page brand brief and visual identity after the name passes clearance.
3. Select the four pilot books and perform the full editorial and illustration audit described in this plan.
4. Open or verify the Nelson Grey LLC KDP account, tax interview, bank details, and public contributor strategy.
5. Choose ISBN strategy before title setup. Because Amazon says coloring books are generally not low-content, verify each title's classification and ISBN eligibility in the live workflow.
6. Upload no more than two titles per week, answer AI questions accurately, approve Print Previewer, and order proofs before publication.
7. Build the imprint landing page, Author Central presence, A+ Content, and measurement spreadsheet before advertising begins.
8. Launch with fixed daily ad caps and review performance weekly against contribution, conversion, quality, and repeat-purchase metrics.
9. Make the Wave 2 decision on day 90. Do not equate completion of the twelve-book files with demonstrated market demand.

# Appendix A Metadata Template

| Field | Template guidance |
|---|---|
| Title | Topic-first, readable, and identical to the cover. |
| Subtitle | Coloring Book for Kids Ages 5–9 with 26 Big Pictures, Names, and Fun Facts. |
| Series | Use the cleared series name consistently; assign sequence only where customer order matters. |
| Contributor | Use the approved public identity consistently; do not put keywords in contributor fields. |
| Description | Open with benefit; list contents and physical format; avoid reviews, URLs, competitor names, and time-sensitive promotions. |

| Field | Template guidance |
|---|---|
| Reading age | 5–9. |
| Categories | Choose up to three categories that accurately match the central topic and children's audience. |
| Keywords | Seven accurate two- or three-word phrases based on parent search intent; no competitor names or claims. |
| AI disclosure | Disclose generated images and any generated text according to the live KDP workflow. |
| Print settings | Paperback; 8.5 by 11; black ink; white paper; confirm bleed setting against final files; matte cover initially. |
| Price | $9.99 U.S. starting point; verify current royalty and print cost before submission. |

# Appendix B Source Notes

| Source | Use in this plan | URL |
|---|---|---|
| Amazon KDP Content Guidelines | AI-generated content disclosure and publisher responsibility for rights. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G200672390 |
| Amazon KDP Paperback Printing Cost | Current large-trim black-ink printing cost and calculation. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G201834340 |
| Amazon KDP Paperback Royalty | Current 50 and 60 percent thresholds and royalty formula. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G201834330 |
| Amazon KDP Metadata Guidelines | Titles, contributors, keywords, reading age, categories, covers, and ISBN guidance. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G201097560 |
| Amazon KDP Low-Content Books | Coloring books listed as not generally low-content; exceptions may apply. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/GGE5T76TWKA85DJM |
| Amazon KDP Create a Book | Current two-title weekly creation and submission limits. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G202172740 |
| Amazon KDP Advertising for Books | Sponsored Products, Author Central prerequisites, budgeting, and A+ Content. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G201499010 |
| Amazon KDP Proof and Author Copies | Proof workflow and physical QA. | https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G7BBN68RYX5UMDZF |
| Publishers Weekly Active Reads | 2025 and 2026 children's activity-book market figures and category trends. | https://www.publishersweekly.com/pw/print/20260817/101056-hot-activity-book-sector-offers-screen-free-fun.html |
| Circana Turning the Page on 2026 Book Trends | Children's, activity-based, and screen-free growth signals. | https://www.circana.com/post/turning-the-page-on-2026-book-trends |
| Jade Summer Kids Catalog | Direct competitor product structure, bold-line positioning, age targets, and community model. | https://jadesummer.com/ |
| Penguin Random House Cozy Days | Major-publisher competitor price, age, format, and bold/easy positioning. | https://www.penguinrandomhouse.com/books/818365/cozy-days-by-coco-wyo/ |
| USPTO-related WONDERWHISK record surfaced by Justia | Reason for rejecting Wonderwhisk as a preferred candidate. | https://trademarks.justia.com/974/95/wonderwhisk-97495988.html |
| Bright Burrow Books | Exact-name commercial collision that disqualifies Bright Burrow Books. | https://www.brightburrowbooks.com/preview/ |

Research status: platform rules, costs, and market figures were checked on October 9, 2026. They can change. Revalidate all platform settings, prices, legal-name availability, and advertising rules immediately before launch.